UX CASE STUDY · CONCEPT PROJECT

First SIP

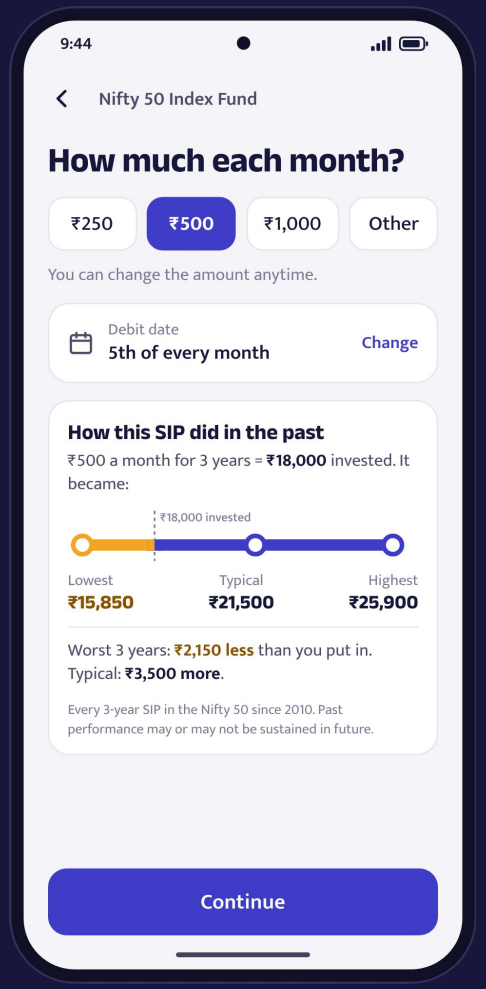
Helping India's first-time investors start their first SIP with confidence

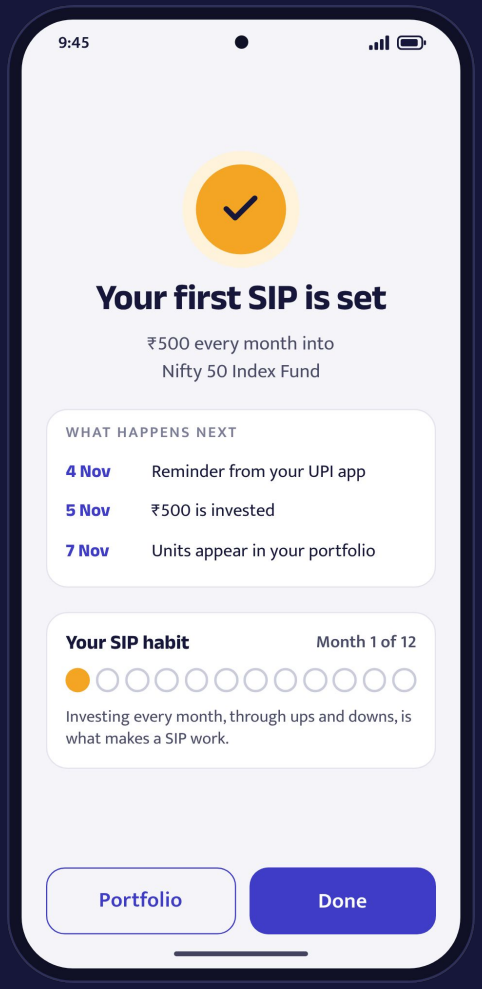
ROLE
Solo designer: research, UX, UI and testing

TIMELINE
3 weeks, Oct 2026

PLATFORM
Android app, English and Hindi

TOOLS
Figma, Google Forms, Google Meet





OVERVIEW

Project at a glance

A goal-first SIP flow for people who finished KYC on an investing app but never made their first investment.

PROBLEM

Young first-timers finish KYC, then stall at fund lists full of returns, ratios and risk labels. Fear of choosing wrong keeps their first ₹500 in a savings account.

APPROACH

A survey of 62 people, 8 interviews, a teardown of 4 investing apps and 1,200 app-store reviews.

SOLUTION

Two questions, a three-fund shortlist in plain words, past results in rupees, and clear control before AutoPay.

OUTCOME

In testing, 5 of 6 first-timers started a SIP without help, versus 2 of 6 on a typical flow.

UNDERSTAND

India's newest investors

59%

of people who registered as investors with NSE in FY27 so far were under 30. Their median age: 27.

₹31,961 cr

went into SIPs in July 2026 alone, from 9.90 crore contributing SIP accounts.

50.3 lakh

SIPs were stopped or completed in July 2026, against 61.4 lakh new ones.

Young people are joining fast, and SIPs are how millions of Indians invest every month. The first SIP is where that habit starts, or stalls.

Sources: NSE Market Pulse, August 2026 (registrations to July 2026); AMFI monthly data for July 2026, as reported by Cafemutual.

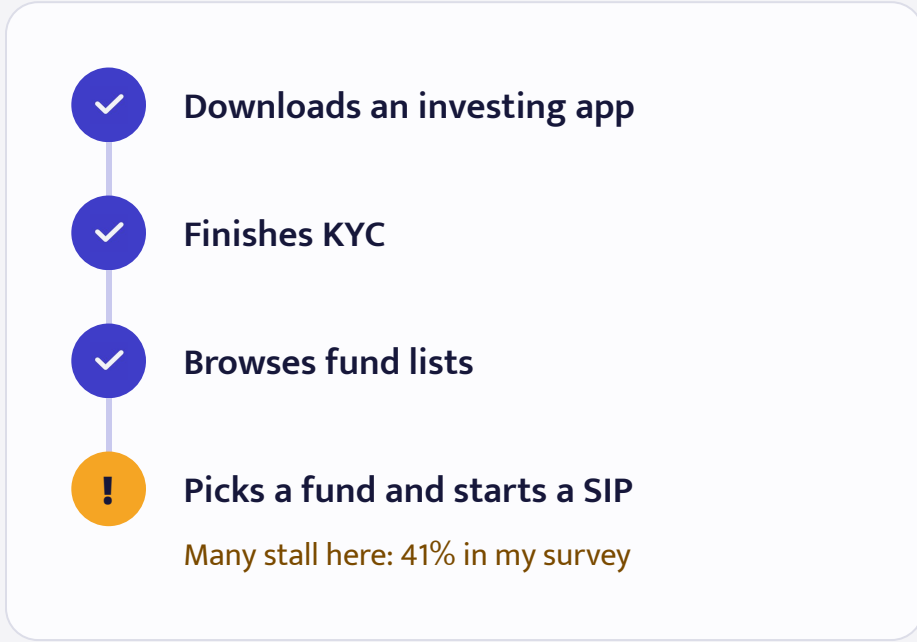
UNDERSTAND

The problem

Young Indians finish KYC on investing apps, then stall before their first SIP.

Fund lists ask them to judge returns, expense ratios and risk labels they don't understand. Fear of picking the wrong fund, and of being locked in, keeps their first ₹500 in a savings account.

41% of my 62 survey respondents had finished KYC but never invested.



UNDERSTAND

Goals and constraints

USER GOAL

Start investing a small amount without fear of picking wrong or losing control of my money.

BUSINESS GOAL

Turn KYC-complete users into active SIP investors, and keep them investing past the first few months.

CONSTRAINTS I DESIGNED WITHIN

No forecasts

SEBI's ad code bars return projections in mutual fund marketing, even with a disclaimer.

Source: SEBI, 2023

No “buy this”

Telling someone which fund to buy can count as investment advice, which needs SEBI registration.

Source: SEBI adviser rules

Required disclosures

Fund screens must carry the riskometer and the standard market-risk line.

Source: SEBI

Budget phones

Screens must work on entry-level Android phones and fit Hindi as well as English.

My design constraint

UNDERSTAND

Research approach

Survey

62 people, aged 21–30

TO LEARN

How many have an investing app but no investments, and what stopped them?

Interviews

8 calls, 30 minutes each

TO LEARN

How do first-timers choose a fund, and what worries them at each step?

App teardown

4 investing apps

TO LEARN

How do today's apps take someone from KYC to a first SIP?

Review mining

1,200 app-store reviews

TO LEARN

Where do new users complain about choosing, onboarding and AutoPay?

Recruited through college groups, LinkedIn and the NextLeap community. Reviews were tagged with the review-analysis tool from my earlier project.

UNDERSTAND

Key insights

01 Choosing, not money, is the blocker

People had money set aside. They stalled at fund lists that ask them to compare returns, ratios and ratings.

6 of 8 interviewees named fund choice as their main blocker

02 “SIP” sounds like a lock-in

Many confused SIPs with tax-saving funds' 3-year lock-in, or with RDs. Few knew they could stop anytime.

5 of 8 thought stopping a SIP has a penalty

03 Percentages feel like a sales pitch

Big past-return numbers raised suspicion. Rupee amounts and honest bad cases felt more trustworthy.

“When an app shows 28% returns, it feels like an ad.” Participant 4

04 AutoPay feels like losing control

A high mandate limit, like ₹1,00,000, reads as a charge, not a ceiling. Unexpected debits are a common fear.

18% of AutoPay-related reviews mention the limit or surprise debits

DEFINE

Primary persona

R

Riya, 24

PROTO-PERSONA

Associate at an IT services firm in Pune. Takes home ₹45,000 a month. Has a savings account and an FD her parents opened.

Finished KYC on an investing app three months ago. Hasn't invested yet.

“I know I should invest. I just don't want to pick the wrong thing.”

GOALS

Build an investing habit, starting small

Stop feeling behind her friends

FRUSTRATIONS

Too many funds, too much jargon

Worried about losing money early on

NEEDS

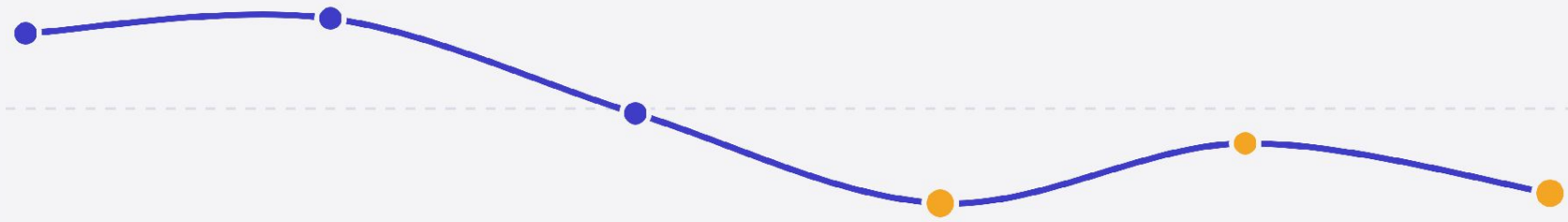
A short list she can trust

Proof she can stop anytime

DEFINE

Current journey

From sign-up to first SIP, based on 8 interviews and the app teardown.



	Signs up	Does KYC	Looks around	Picks a fund	Sets amount	Sets AutoPay
THINKING	“Everyone's investing. I should start.”	“Done! That was easy.”	“Index, flexi cap, ELSS... where do I even start?”	“What if I pick the wrong one?”	“Can I stop if I need the money?”	“Why is the limit ₹1,00,000?”
OPPORTUNITY	**Give one clear first step**	**Turn the KYC win into momentum**	**Ask about goals, not categories**	**Shortlist three funds, in plain words**	**Explain pause, stop and withdraw**	**Set the limit to the SIP amount**

DESIGN CHALLENGE

How might we help a first-time investor start a small SIP with confidence?

Success means she starts in under three minutes, and can explain what she bought and how to stop it.

DEFINE

Design principles

FROM INSIGHT 01

Ask about life, not funds

Start from goals and comfort with dips. Let the app do the filtering.

FROM INSIGHTS 01 AND 03

Rupees, not jargon

Show costs, fees and past results as rupee amounts people can picture.

FROM INSIGHTS 02 AND 04

Control before commitment

Explain how to pause, stop and withdraw before asking for AutoPay.

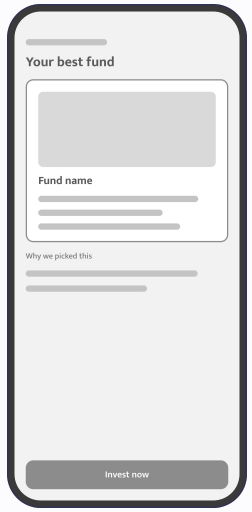
FROM INSIGHT 03

Honest about risk

Show real bad years, in rupees. Never forecast returns.

DESIGN

Three directions I explored



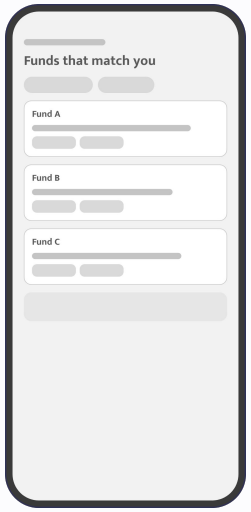
DIRECTION A

Quiz, then one fund

For: fewest steps.

Against: reads as advice, hides the trade-offs, nothing to compare.

Dropped



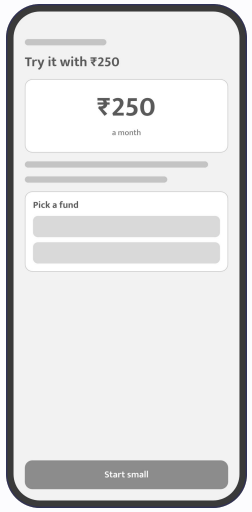
DIRECTION B

Goal, then a shortlist

For: guided, but she decides, and the criteria are visible.

Against: one more choice to make.

Chosen



DIRECTION C

Try ₹250 first

For: lowers the stakes with the ₹250 Chhoti SIP for first-time investors.

Against: doesn't solve choosing.

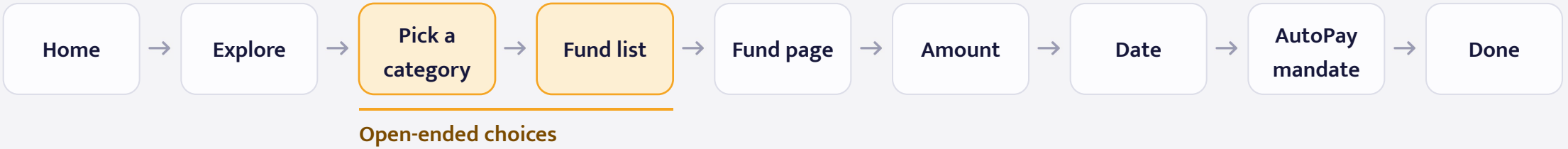
Folded into B

I chose B, and kept C's ₹250 option on the amount screen.

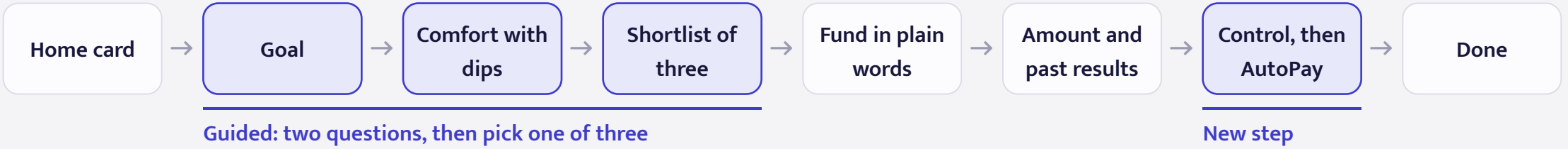
DESIGN

The new flow

TYPICAL FLOW TODAY



FIRST SIP FLOW



One step fewer, and no open-ended choice: two questions and a pick from three replace a category menu and a fund list.

DESIGN · SCREENS 1 AND 2

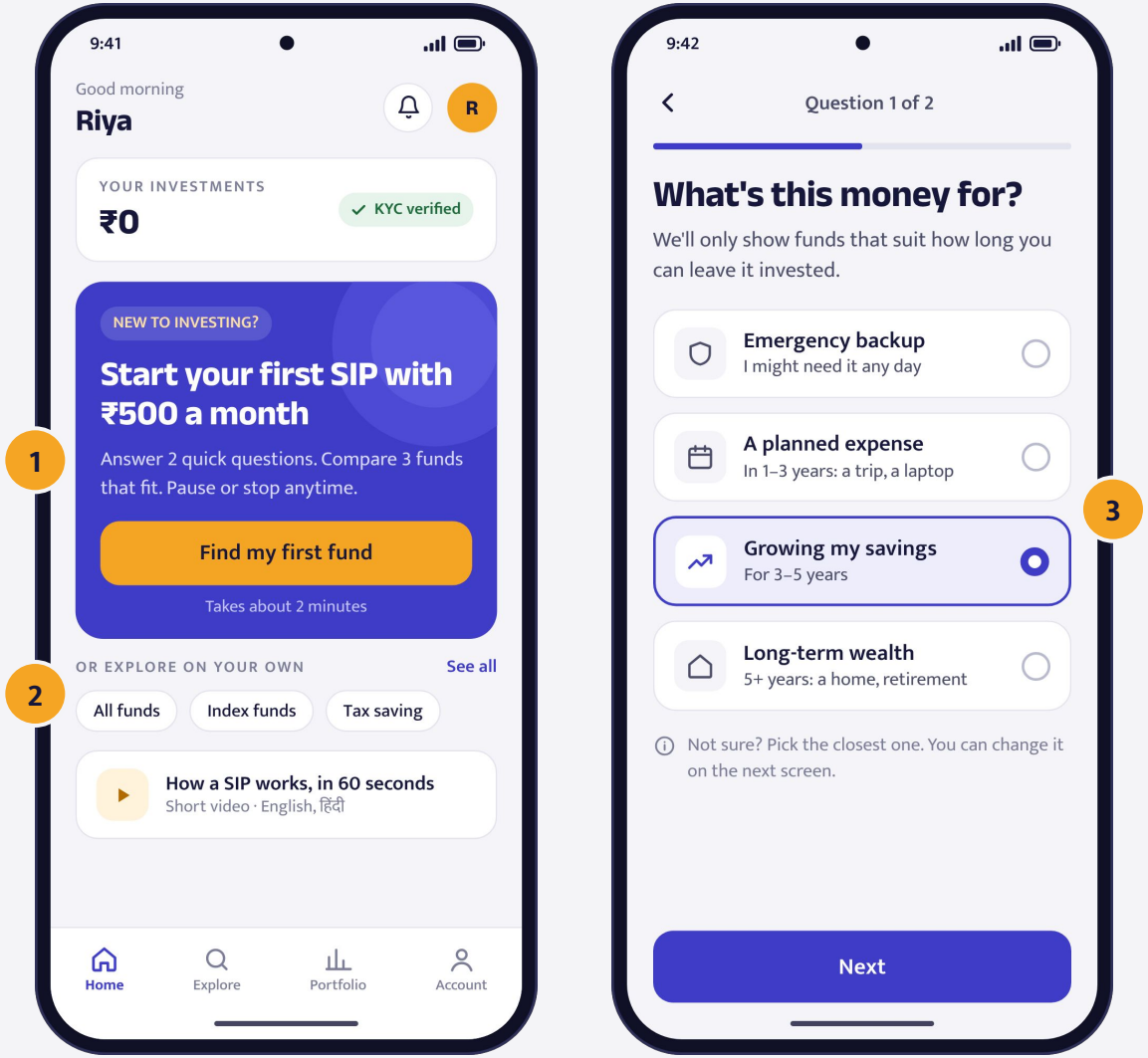
Start from a goal

People who finished KYC but never invested get one clear next step, and questions about life instead of funds.

1. **One clear first step**
   The home card speaks only to people with KYC done and nothing invested.

2. **Browsing stays open**
   Confident users can still explore every fund. Nothing is hidden.

3. **Goals replace jargon**
   Time frame matters most, so it's asked as a life goal, not “investment horizon”.



DESIGN · SCREENS 3 AND 4

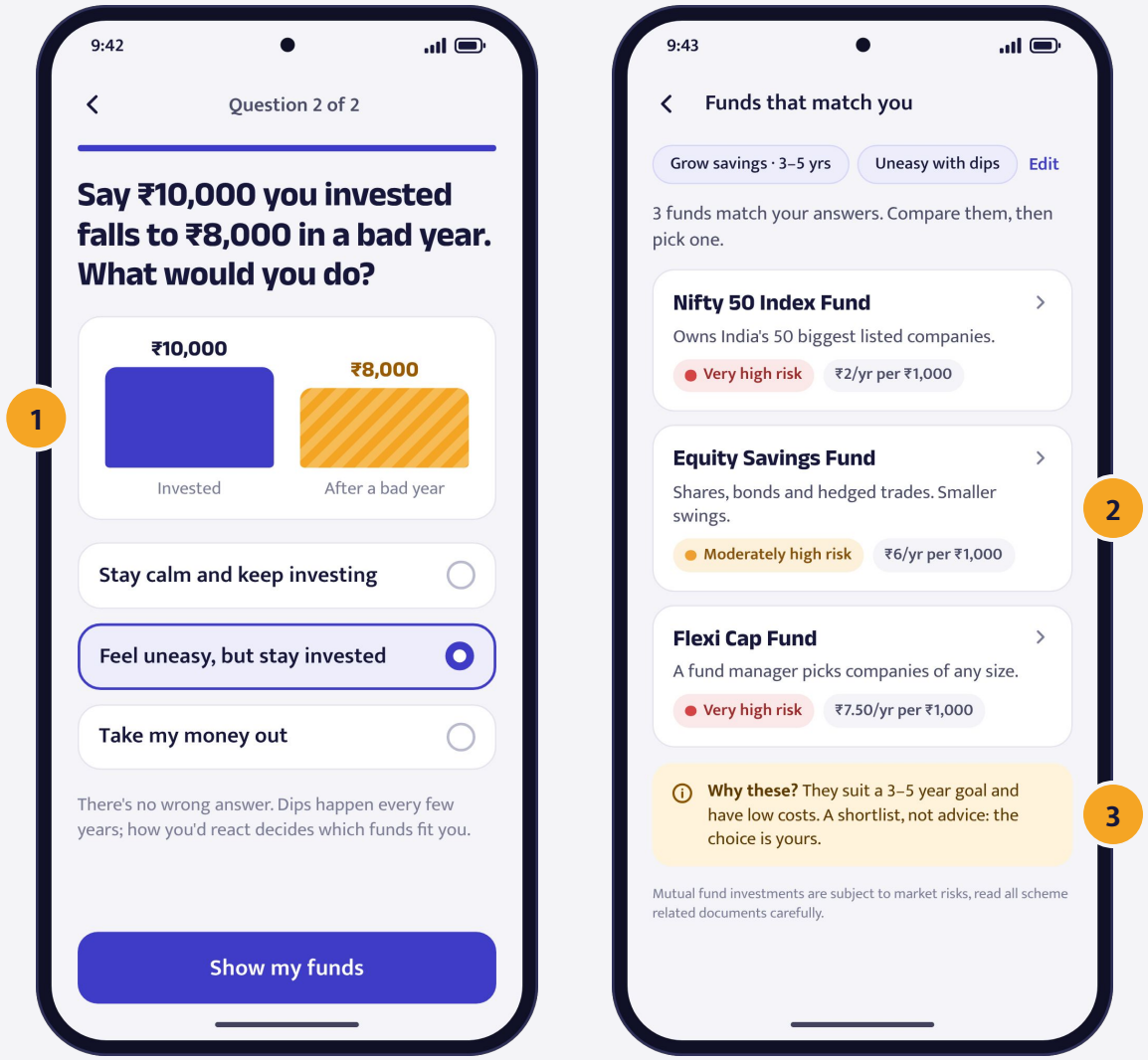
Choose from three

Two answers narrow hundreds of funds to three she can actually compare.

1 **Risk, asked in rupees**
A ₹10,000-to-₹8,000 picture replaces a 1-to-10 risk scale.

2 **Cards in plain words**
What the fund owns, its risk label and its yearly cost per ₹1,000.

3 **A shortlist, not advice**
The criteria are on screen and the pick stays with her, so the app filters rather than advises.



DESIGN · SCREENS 5 AND 6

Know what you buy

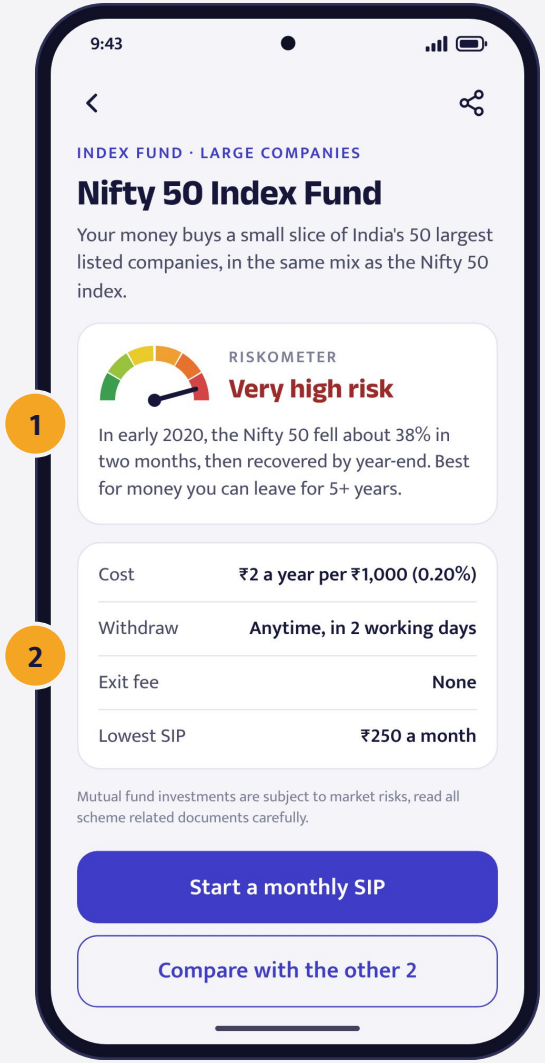
Every number is in rupees, and every risk comes with a real example.

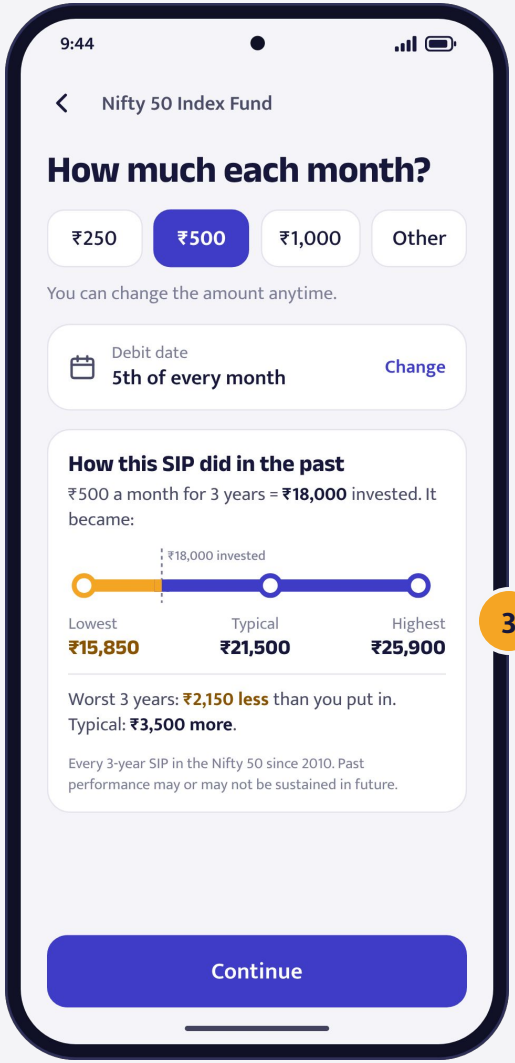
1. **The riskometer, translated**
   The required riskometer stays, next to a real bad year: the Nifty 50 fell about 38% in early 2020.

2. **Costs in rupees**
   “₹2 a year per ₹1,000” says more than “0.20% expense ratio”.

3. **Past results, not forecasts**
   Real 3-year SIP outcomes, including a loss, instead of a projection the ad code doesn't allow.

Fund names and figures in these screens are sample data.





DESIGN · SCREENS 7 AND 8

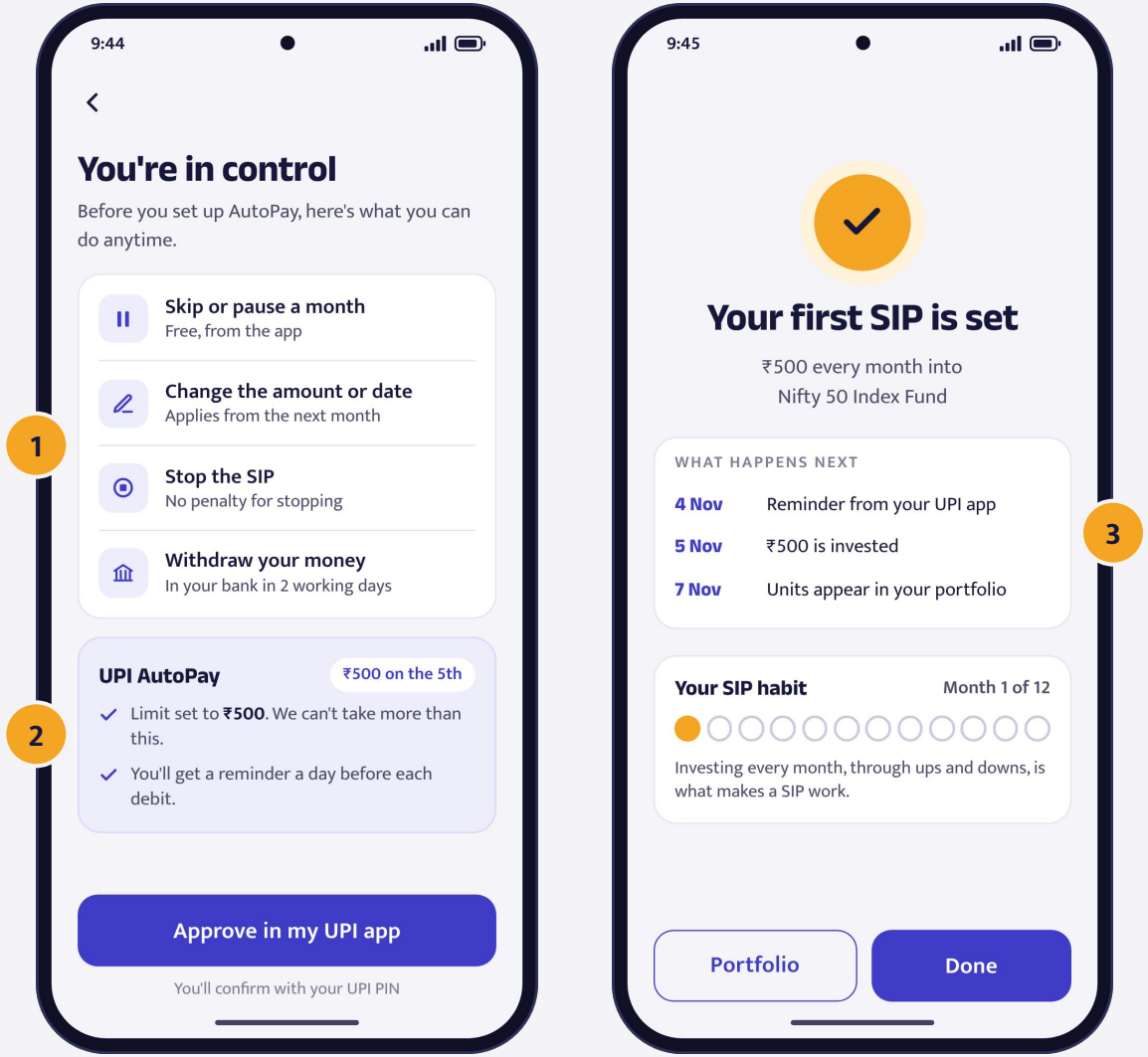
Control first

She learns how to stop before she's asked to start.

1. **Control before commitment**
   Pause, change, stop and withdraw are explained before AutoPay is set up.

2. **A limit she can trust**
   The AutoPay limit matches her SIP, and she's reminded a day before each debit.

3. **No "where's my money?"**
   Dated next steps, then a habit tracker that frames ₹500 as month one of twelve.



DESIGN

Words that build trust

TYPICAL WORDING	FIRST SIP WORDING
Set up AutoPay mandate. Maximum amount: ₹1,00,000	**Approve ₹500 on the 5th of each month. We can't take more than that.**
Riskometer: Very High	**Very high risk: it can fall a lot in a bad year. Best for money you can leave for 5+ years.**
Exit load: 1% if redeemed within 365 days	**Withdrawing in the first year costs 1%, so ₹10 on every ₹1,000.**
Expense ratio: 0.20%	**Costs ₹2 a year for every ₹1,000 invested.**

Written to translate cleanly: short sentences, no idioms. In Hindi: **₹500 हर महीने। जब चाहें रोकें।**

VALIDATE

One key iteration

A compliance check on my first draft changed two core decisions.

1. **From one pick to a shortlist**
   Version 1 suggested a single fund, which can count as advice. Version 2 shows three, with its criteria.

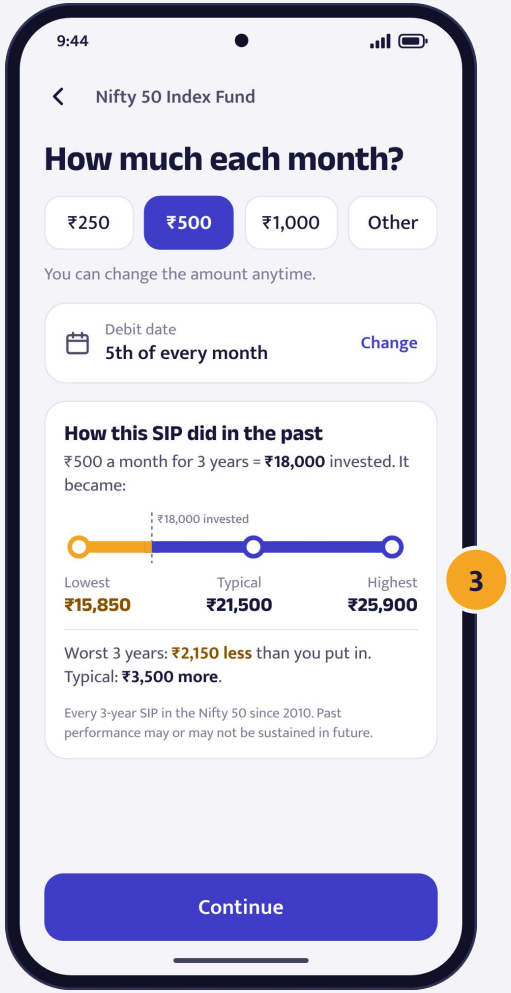
2. **From forecast to past results**
   Version 1 projected future value, which the ad code bars. Version 2 shows how real SIPs did.

3. **More honest, too**
   The past range includes a loss. In testing, 5 of 6 said this made the numbers more believable.

VERSION 1



VERSION 2



VALIDATE

Usability testing

SETUP

6 first-time investors, in moderated sessions on Google Meet. Each tried a typical app flow and the First SIP prototype.

TASKS

1. Start a ₹500 monthly SIP for a goal you choose.
2. Find out how to get your money back.
3. Skip next month's instalment.

MEASURE	TYPICAL FLOW	FIRST SIP
Started a SIP without help	2 of 6	**5 of 6**
Median time to first SIP	6:40	**2:50**
Confidence afterwards, out of 5	2.6	**4.3**
Knew they could stop anytime	1 of 6	**6 of 6**

WHAT I CHANGED AFTER TESTING

3 of 6 worried AutoPay could take more than ₹500, so the limit now leads the AutoPay card.

2 of 6 couldn't get back to the shortlist, so the fund page gained “Compare with the other 2”.

VALIDATE

Measuring success

NORTH STAR

Share of KYC-complete users who start a first SIP within 7 days

FUNNEL

Drop-off at each step: questions, shortlist, fund page, amount and AutoPay approval.

HABIT

Share of first SIPs still running after three instalments.

GUARDRAILS

Cancellations within 30 days, failed debits, and complaints about unexpected debits.

Launch plan: A/B test against the current flow with new KYC-complete users for 2 weeks. Ship if first SIPs rise and the guardrails hold.

REFLECT

What I learned

Constraints made it better

The ad code ruled out forecasts. Showing how real past SIPs turned out, in rupees, was more honest and more useful.

Fewer choices, more confidence

For a nervous first-timer, removing options helps more than explaining them.

Next time

Test on budget Android phones and with Hindi-first users from day one, and review the shortlist logic with a compliance expert.

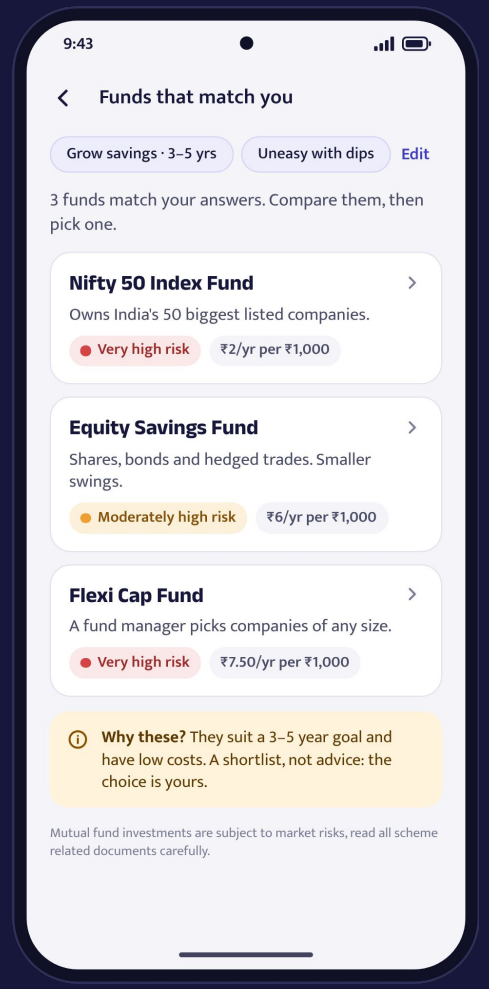
NEXT STEPS

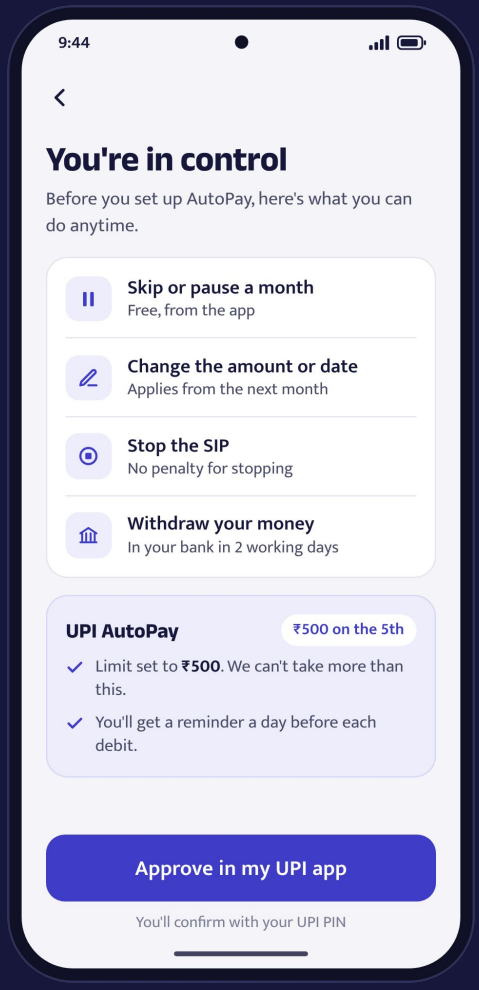
Prototype the pause and stop flows, test with 10 more first-timers, and track 3-month SIP retention after launch.

FIRST SIP · UX CASE STUDY

Thank you

Happy to walk you through the research, the trade-offs or the Figma file.





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